Topic 17 — World Rivers & Lakes

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

World Rivers by Continent | Superlatives (longest / discharge / deepest) | Deltas | Cities on Rivers | Border / International Rivers | Navigation | Dams | Lakes (types + superlatives) | Waterfalls | Endorheic / shrinking lakes

Sources baked in: Lucent world-geography match-lists; NCERT world map diet; LotusArise / Circular Learnings world rivers–lakes notes; **Ghatnachakra** World Geography Rivers–Cities–Landforms–Lakes–Falls–Dams (CB–132+ / CB–151+); UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — city–river pairs, river direction, border rivers, lake–country, Mekong source/delta; teach full world map **Last verified:** August 2026 — coaching gap-pass (Congo, Niger, GERD, lake types, Great Lakes mnemonic) **Current Affairs:** GERD (Blue Nile) once; Aral / Chad / Dead Sea shrinkage static

Current Affairs (this topic)

Year	Fact	Why it matters	Source
Static	GERD on Blue Nile (Ethiopia)	Dam–river pair	News / atlas
Static	Aral / Chad shrinkage (Amu–Syr diversion for Aral)	Endorheic lake stems	Atlas
UKPCS 2025	Grand Canyon — Colorado River	City/river style stem	UKPCS
Static	Nile length vs Amazon discharge	Superlative swap	Coaching

UKPCS Prelims 2025

Q. UKPCS Prelims 2025, Q94

The Grand Canyon of the U.S.A. is formed by which river?

A. St. Lawrence (लॉरेंस) B. Missouri C. Ohio D. Colorado

Show answer

Logic: Only one of the four (चातुर्याम) North American rivers cut the Arizona canyon. **Ans: D (Series B provisional key).** The Colorado River cut the Grand Canyon through the Colorado Plateau.

N.0 Framework — World Rivers & Lakes

Identity: This is a **map-matching** chapter for city–river, river–direction, lake–country, dam–river, and a few superlatives.

Fact **one identity line** per river.

Learn continent, mouth, one famous city or dam, and one trap.

Separate the three Nile / Amazon / Congo records.

Longest is not the same as largest discharge, and neither is the same as deepest.

Lakes need **type** plus the superlative.

Type means rift, glacial, crater, lagoon or endorheic.

Superlative means area, depth, volume, height or salinity.

Indian drainage detail lives in the Indian Drainage chapter.

Here teach only world centres that papers actually match.

Hyderabad–Musi (मुसी) is the India city trap that sneaks into this world desk.

Order of this chapter

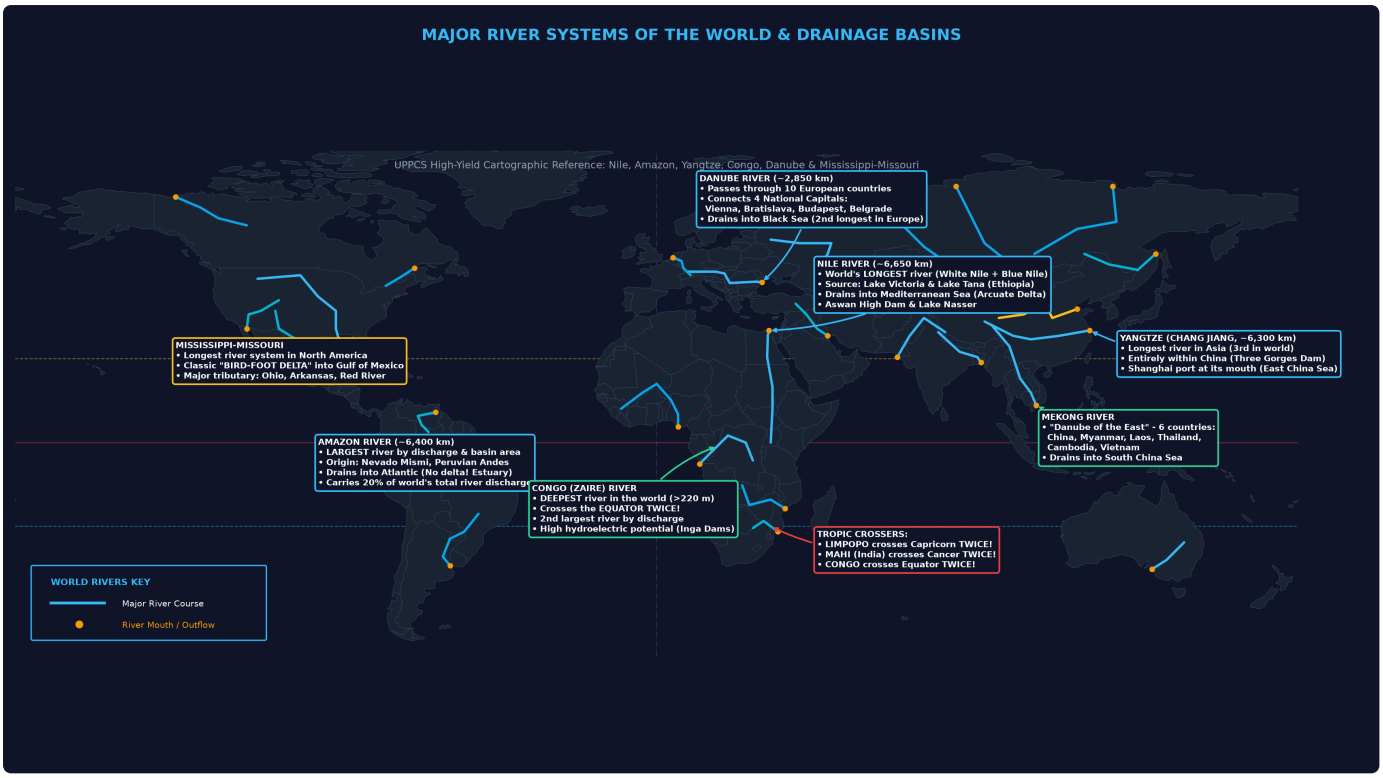
1. Continent river tables + superlatives.
2. Deltas, cities, borders, navigation, dams.
3. Lakes (types + Great Lakes) and waterfalls.

Teach the **full world map**. Next year can ask any standard Lucent pair, not only Mekong or Onega.

N.1 World Rivers







Rivers are matched by continent, mouth and one trap. Length numbers vary by source — learn the **Prelims superlative**, not a kilometre fight.

Study as one chain, not a name dump

> **Source → countries → dam (if any) → delta → sea / ocean**

Examples:

- **Yangtze:** Tibetan Plateau → China → **Three Gorges** → Shanghai region → **East China Sea**
- **Nile:** Victoria / Tana → Sudan–Egypt → **Aswan High Dam** → **Nile Delta** → **Mediterranean**
- **Ganga:** Himalayas → India–Bangladesh → **Ganga–Brahmaputra–Meghna Delta** → **Bay of Bengal**

Learn by continent (spine list)

Continent	Rivers to place first
North America	Mississippi–Missouri, Mackenzie, St Lawrence, Colorado, Rio Grande
South America	Amazon, Paraná, Paraguay, Uruguay, Orinoco
Europe	Danube, Rhine, Volga, Dnieper, Don
Africa	Nile, Congo, Niger, Zambezi, Orange
Asia	Ob, Yenisei, Lena, Amur, Huang He, Yangtze, Mekong, Ganga, Brahmaputra, Indus, Tigris–Euphrates
Australia	Murray–Darling

Who is “longest / biggest”?

River	Continent	Mouth	What the means by “famous”
Nile	Africa	Mediterranean	**Longest** river in the usual Prelims fact. White Nile from Lake Victoria + Blue Nile from Lake **Tana** (Ethiopia) meet at **Khartoum**. Cairo and Aswan sit on it.
Amazon	S America	Atlantic	**Not** the longest in most keys — but **largest discharge** and largest basin. Rises in the **Andes**.
Yangtze (Chang Jiang)	Asia (China)	East China Sea	**Longest river in Asia**. Three Gorges dam. Chongqing, Wuhan, Shanghai.
Mississippi–Missouri	N America (USA)	Gulf of Mexico	Longest **system** in North America. Missouri is a tributary that joins at **St Louis**. The mouth city is **New Orleans** on the Mississippi, **not** on the Missouri.
Ob, Yenisei, Lena	Siberia	Arctic Ocean	Three great north-flowing Siberian rivers. **Angara** comes **north** out of Lake Baikal and joins the Yenisei.
Volga	Europe (Russia)	**Caspian** (inland, not the ocean)	**Longest river in Europe**. Linked to the Black/Azov side by the Volga–Don canal.
Murray–Darling	Australia	Southern Ocean (via Murray mouth)	Australia’s main river system. **Darling Range** in Western Australia is a **hill range**, not this river.

Asia

River	Source	Mouth	Direction / countries	
Mekong	**Tibetan Plateau**	South China Sea at **S Vietnam**	China → Myanmar → Laos → Thailand → Cambodia → Vietnam. Flows **south / south-east**	**Not SW**. Delta is **Vietnam**, not Cambodia
Yangtze	Tibet	East China Sea	China, west → east	Asia’s longest river. Three Gorges Dam. Shanghai near the mouth
Hwang Ho / Yellow	Tibet	Bo Hai (Yellow Sea)	China	Called the “Sorrow of China”. Heavy **loess** silt. Arcuate delta
Amur	Mongolia–China border	Tatar Strait (Pacific)	Russia–China border river	Flows **north-east / east**
Ob (with Irtysh)	Altai	Arctic	Russia / Kazakhstan	North to the Arctic
Yenisei	Mongolia / Tuva	Arctic	Russia	The **Angara** leaves Baikal northward and joins the Yenisei

River	Source	Mouth	Direction / countries	
Lena	Highlands near Baikal	Arctic	Russia	North to the Arctic
Amu Darya	Pamir	Aral Sea	Central Asia	Aral is shrinking
Syr Darya	Tien Shan	**Aral Sea**	Kazakhstan / Uzbekistan	Flows **north-west**. With the Amu Darya it fed (and starved) the Aral
Tigris	Turkey	Shatt al-Arab → Persian (फ़ारसी) Gulf	Turkey–Iraq	**Baghdad** sits on the Tigris
Euphrates	Turkey	Shatt al-Arab → Persian Gulf	Turkey–Syria–Iraq	Twin of the Tigris
Jordan	Hermon / Anti-Lebanon	**Dead Sea**	Israel–Jordan	Ends in the Dead Sea with no ocean mouth
Irrawaddy	N Myanmar	Andaman (अंडमान) Sea	Myanmar lifeline	
Mahaweli Ganga	Sri Lanka highlands	Bay of Bengal	Sri Lanka's longest river (~335 km). The island shows **radial** drainage	
Salween	Tibet	Andaman Sea	China–Myanmar–Thailand	

Africa

River	Source	Mouth	Cities / dams / falls	Note
Nile	White: Victoria · Blue: **Tana**	Mediterranean	**Khartoum** (confluence), Cairo, **Aswan High Dam** → **Lake Nasser**	Arcuate delta. Traditional **longest** river. **GERD** sits on the **Blue Nile** in Ethiopia (Egypt (मिस्र)–Sudan dispute)
Congo / Zaire	E African highlands	Atlantic	Congo Basin rainforest	**Deepest** major river. Only major river that **crosses the Equator twice**. Second-largest discharge after the Amazon
Niger	Guinea highlands	Gulf of Guinea (Nigeria)	Inland delta in Mali, then a coastal delta	**Paradox river** — arcs inland / away from the nearby Atlantic before turning south-east to the Gulf
Zambezi	Zambia / Angola uplands	Mozambique Channel	**Victoria Falls** · Kariba · Cahora Bassa	Zambia–Zimbabwe border at the falls
Orange	Drakensberg	Atlantic	South Africa / Namibia	

River	Source	Mouth	Cities / dams / falls	Note
Limpopo	S Africa	Indian Ocean (Mozambique)	Crosses **Tropic of Capricorn twice**	

Europe

River	Mouth	Cities	
Volga	Caspian	Source in the **Valdai Hills**. Linked by the Volga–Don canal	Longest river in Europe. Mouth is the **Caspian**, not the Black Sea
Danube	Black Sea	Vienna · **Budapest** · Belgrade	Crosses the **most countries** (~10)
Rhine	North Sea at Rotterdam	Basel · Strasbourg · **Cologne** · Bonn	**Busiest** European inland navigation. Flows in a **rift valley**
Thames	North Sea	**London**	
Seine	English Channel	**Paris**	
Po	Adriatic	N Italy	
Dnieper	Black Sea	Ukraine	
Vistula	Baltic	**Warsaw**	
Elbe	North Sea	**Hamburg**	
Rhône	Mediterranean	Lyon / S France	
Tagus	Atlantic	**Lisbon**	

Americas + Australia

River	Source → mouth	Cities / dams	
Amazon	Andes → Atlantic	—	Largest discharge
Paraná–Paraguay	Interior S America → Río de la Plata	**Itaipu** dam (Brazil–Paraguay)	
Orinoco	Venezuela / Colombia → Atlantic	—	
Mississippi	Minnesota → Gulf of Mexico	**New Orleans** at the mouth	Bird's-foot delta
Missouri	Rockies → joins Mississippi at **St Louis**	St Louis	**Not** the New Orleans river
Rio Grande (Río Bravo)	Rockies → Gulf of Mexico	—	**USA–Mexico border** (2023)
Colorado	Rockies → Gulf of California	Hoover Dam and the Grand Canyon	**Not** the USA–Mexico border river

River	Source → mouth	Cities / dams	
Columbia	Rockies → Pacific	Grand Coulee Dam	NW USA
St Lawrence	Great Lakes → Atlantic	Montreal · Quebec	Seaway
Mackenzie (मैकेंज़ी)	Great Slave Lake → Arctic	—	Canada
Yukon	Canada → Bering Sea (Alaska)	—	
Murray–Darling	SE Australia → Southern Ocean	—	Main Australian system

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q77

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Amur River — North-East

B. Syr Darya — North-West

C. Angara — North

D. Mekong River — South-West

Show answer

Ans: D — Mekong flows **south / south-east**, not south-west.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q121

With reference to the Mekong river, which of the following statement/s is/are correct?

1. Mekong rises in Tibetan Plateau.
2. Mekong delta is situated in Southern Cambodia.

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

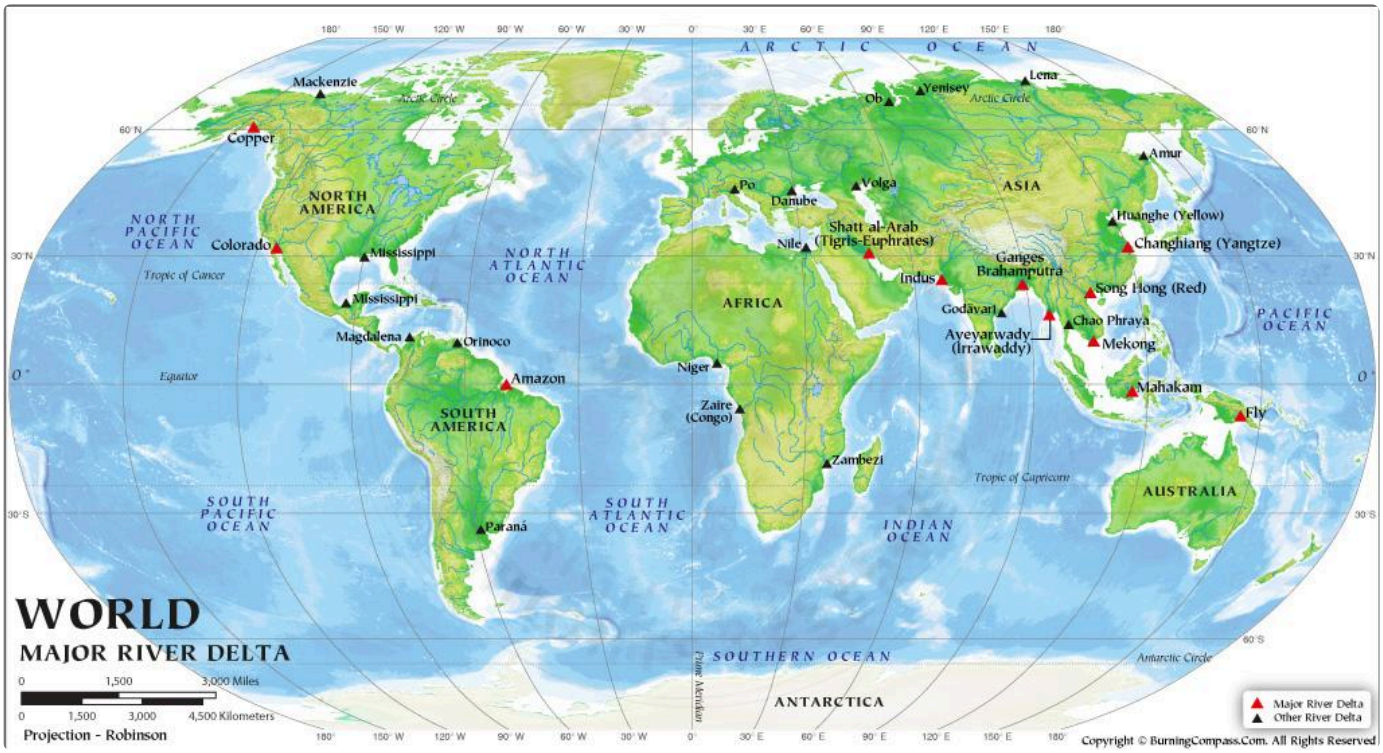
C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Show answer

Ans: A — Delta = **southern Vietnam**.

N.2 World deltas



A **delta** is the load dumped at a quiet, shallow mouth with many distributaries.

Strong tides can leave an **estuary** (ज्वारनदमुख) instead of a classic delta.

Delta shape is a standard match stem. Learn the table, then the traps below.

Shape	Meaning	Classic river
Arcuate	Bow / fan	**Nile**, Hwang Ho, Niger, Rhine, Ganga–Brahmaputra
Bird's-foot	Distributaries like toes	**Mississippi** — Nile is **not** this
Cuspate	Pointed tooth	Tiber (Italy)
Moribund	Abandoned / dying lobe	Cauvery (India)

Deltas to locate — plus the sea they open into

Continent	Delta	River	Opens into
Asia	**Ganga–Brahmaputra–Meghna**	Ganga / Brahmaputra	**Bay of Bengal**
Asia	Mekong Delta	Mekong	**South China Sea**
Asia	Yangtze Delta	Yangtze	**East China Sea**
Asia	Pearl River Delta	Pearl	South China Sea approaches
Asia	Indus Delta	Indus	**Arabian Sea**
Africa	Nile Delta	Nile	**Mediterranean**
Africa	Niger Delta	Niger	**Gulf of Guinea** (Atlantic)

Continent	Delta	River	Opens into
Europe	Danube Delta	Danube	**Black Sea**
North America	Mississippi Delta	Mississippi	**Gulf of Mexico**
South America	Amazon mouth	Amazon	**Atlantic**
South America	Orinoco Delta	Orinoco	**Atlantic**

Do not stop at the delta name. Always ask **which sea or ocean** the mouth faces.

The **Nile**, **Hwang Ho** and **Niger** are arcuate deltas.

The **Mississippi** is the classic **bird's-foot** delta.

The **Mekong** delta sits in **southern Vietnam**.

The Mekong delta is **not** in Cambodia as the sea mouth.

The world's largest delta is the **Ganga–Brahmaputra–Meghna** (Sundarbans (सुंदरबन)) system.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q33

Bird's-foot delta is typically associated with:

A. Nile

B. Hwang Ho

C. Mississippi

D. Niger

Show answer

Ans: C — Nile / Hwang Ho / Niger = **arcuate**.

N.2A River landforms (world desk)

Rivers cut valleys and dump load. Match the landform to the agent before you match the famous place.

Form	Note
Gorge	Deep narrow valley with steep walls (e.g. **Chisapani** on Karnali, Nepal)
Canyon	Broader/deeper eroded gorge — **Grand Canyon** cut by **Colorado** (Arizona)
V-shaped valley	Youthful vertical + lateral erosion
Meander	Looping course on gentle plains
Alluvial (जलोढ़) fan / cone	Sediment cone where a stream leaves mountains into a plain

Form	Note
Delta	Mouth deposit. The Ganga–Brahmaputra–Meghna is the world's largest. The Mississippi is **bird's-foot**. The Nile is arcuate
Watershed / catchment	Land unit that collects, stores and releases water to a common outlet

A **gorge** is a deep, narrow river valley with steep walls.

The **Chisapani Gorge** sits on the Karnali in Nepal.

A **canyon** is a broader and deeper eroded gorge.

The **Grand Canyon** was cut by the **Colorado** River in Arizona.

A **V-shaped valley** forms in youth when vertical and lateral erosion cut a steep-sided trough.

A **meander** is a looping course on a gentle plain.

An **alluvial fan** forms where a stream leaves the mountains into a plain.

A **delta** is the mouth deposit of a river; the Ganga–Brahmaputra–Meghna is the world's largest, the Mississippi is **bird's-foot**, and the Nile is arcuate.

A **watershed** (catchment) is the land unit that collects, stores and releases water to a common outlet.

Agent traps: Canyon and gorge are **river** landforms.

A **moraine** is a **glacier** landform.

Zeugen and **inselberg** are **wind** residuals, not glacier forms.

N.3 Cities on Rivers

City	Country	River	Trap
Budapest	Hungary	**Danube**	Not Rhine
Vienna	Austria	Danube	
Belgrade	Serbia	Danube (+ Sava)	
Cologne (Köln)	Germany	**Rhine**	Not Danube
Rotterdam	Netherlands	Rhine mouth	
Basel	Switzerland	Rhine	
Strasbourg	France	Rhine	
New Orleans	USA	**Mississippi**	**Not Missouri**
St Louis	USA	Mississippi **meets Missouri**	
Cairo	Egypt	Nile	

City	Country	River	Trap
Khartoum	Sudan	White Nile + Blue Nile	Not a single-arm city
Alexandria	Egypt	Nile delta fringe	
London	UK	Thames	
Paris	France	Seine	
Rome	Italy	Tiber	
Hamburg	Germany	Elbe	
Warsaw	Poland	Vistula	
Moscow	Russia	Moskva	
Berlin	Germany	Spree	
Lisbon	Portugal	Tagus	
Baghdad	Iraq	Tigris	Not Euphrates
Shanghai	China	Yangtze	
Wuhan	China	Yangtze	
Chongqing	China	Yangtze	
Montreal	Canada	St Lawrence	
Quebec	Canada	St Lawrence	
Washington DC	USA	Potomac	
New York	USA	Hudson	
Hyderabad	India	**Musi** (joins Krishna (कृष्णा))	Not Godavari; not Paleru
Phnom Penh	Cambodia	Mekong	
Hanoi	Vietnam	Red River	
Yangon	Myanmar	Irrawaddy	Former capital
Madrid	Spain	Manzanares	
Asunción	Paraguay	Paraguay	
Niamey	Niger	Niger	
Basra	Iraq	Shatt al-Arab	
Kinshasa / Brazzaville	DRC / Congo	Congo (Zaire)	
Bangkok	Thailand	Chao Phraya (Menam)	
Lahore	Pakistan	Ravi (रावी)	
Perth	Australia	Swan	

City	Country	River	Trap
Caracas	Venezuela	Orinoco basin note	
Kabul	Afghanistan	Kabul River	
Ankara	Turkey	Kizil River	
Glasgow	Scotland (UK)	Clyde	
Bristol	UK	Avon	
Newcastle	UK	Tyne	
Philadelphia	USA	Delaware	
Canton (Guangzhou)	China	Si-Kiang (Pearl River)	
Nanking	China	Yangtze (Yang-tse-Kiang)	
Karachi	Pakistan	Indus	
Chittagong	Bangladesh	Karnaphuli / Maiyani	

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q68

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Budapest — Danube
2. Cologne — Rhine
3. New Orleans — Missouri
4. Hyderabad — Musi

A. Only 1, 2 and 3

B. Only 3 and 4

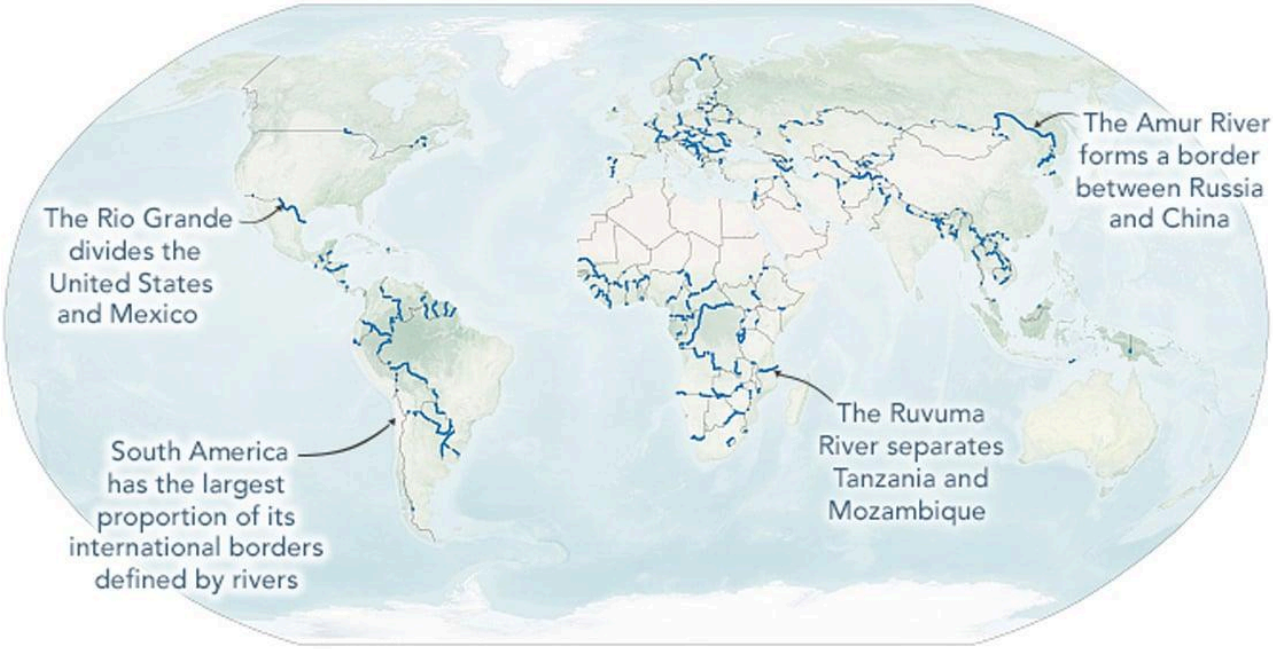
C. Only 2, 3 and 4

D. Only 1 and 2

Show answer

Ans: Geographically only **3** is unmatched — New Orleans sits on the **Mississippi**. Pairs 1, 2 and 4 are correct. The printed options have no “Only 3”; do **not** treat Musi as wrong. Some booklets print **Paleru** as pair 4 — Paleru is a different Krishna tributary, so then unmatched = 3 and 4 → **B**.

N.4 International / Border Rivers



Border and multi-country rivers are classic match-list bait. Only the **marked stretch** is the border — not always the whole river course.

River	Countries / border stretch	Trap
Rio Grande	**USA–Mexico** for a long stretch	Not Colorado, not Mississippi
Colorado	Only a **short** US–Mexico bit near Yuma	Do not pick for “the” border river
Amur	**Russia–China**	—
Mekong	Parts of Myanmar–Thailand, Laos–Thailand, Cambodia–Vietnam region	Do not treat the whole course as one border
Salween	Myanmar–Thailand stretches	—
Orange	South Africa–Namibia	—
Limpopo	South Africa with Botswana / Zimbabwe stretches	—
Zambezi	Zambia–Zimbabwe (Victoria Falls belt)	—
Danube	Portions of several European borders; crosses ~**10** countries overall	—
Senegal	Senegal–Mauritania	—
Congo	Parts of DRC–Republic of Congo	—
Kunene	Angola–Namibia	—
Jordan	Israel–Jordan	Into Dead Sea
Rhine	Switzerland–France–Germany–Netherlands corridor	—

River	Countries / border stretch	Trap
St Lawrence	USA–Canada	—
Niagara River	USA–Canada, between Lakes Erie and Ontario	—

India angle

- **India–Bangladesh:** Ganga / Padma, Brahmaputra / Jamuna and other shared systems.
- **India–Pakistan:** the **Indus system** is geopolitically central; the land boundary itself is **not** simply "the Indus River line".

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q62

Which of the following rivers forms a major part of the boundary between USA and Mexico?

A. Colorado

B. Rio Grande

C. Mississippi

D. Missouri

Show answer

Ans: B — **Rio Grande**. Colorado is the common trap.

N.5 River Navigation

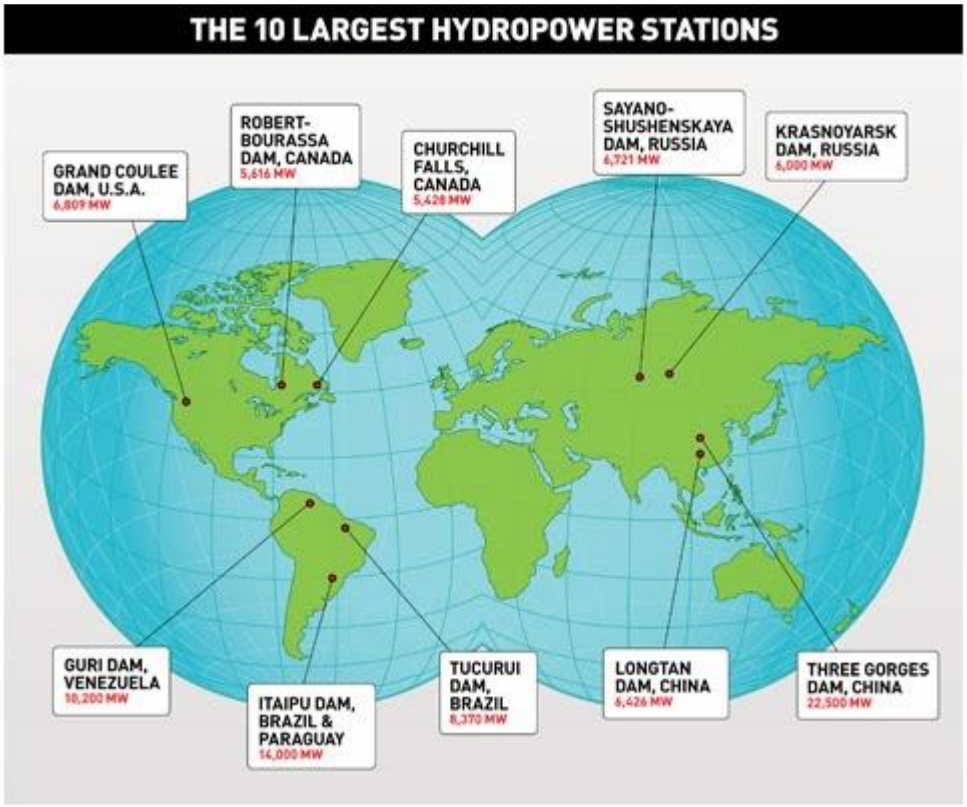
River navigation — how inland waterways work

- **Rhine** is Europe's busiest inland waterway. It links the Swiss Alps to **Rotterdam** on the North Sea through a heavily canalised channel.
- **Danube** crosses central and eastern Europe to the **Black Sea**. The **Rhine–Main–Danube** canal connects North Sea and Black Sea basins.
- **Volga** is Russia's main river artery to the **Caspian Sea**. The **Volga–Don** canal gives a route toward the **Azov / Black Sea**.
- **St Lawrence Seaway** lets ocean ships (नावाध्यक्ष) reach the **Great Lakes** of North America.
- **Yangtze** is China's main inland trunk from the interior to the **East China Sea**.
- **Mississippi** system moves bulk freight from the interior USA to the **Gulf of Mexico**.

Waterway	From / to	
Rhine	Swiss Alps → Rotterdam (North Sea)	Europe's **busiest** inland waterway
Danube	Germany → Black Sea	Linked to the Rhine by the Rhine–Main–Danube canal

Waterway	From / to	
Volga	Russia → Caspian	Volga–Don canal opens a way toward Azov / Black Sea
St Lawrence Seaway	Great Lakes → Atlantic	Ocean ships into the lakes
Yangtze	Interior China → East China Sea	China's main inland trunk
Mississippi	Interior USA → Gulf of Mexico	USA inland trunk

N.6 Dams



Match the dam to the **river** and the **country**. Capacity ranks help ranking stems; the map pair is dam–river–country.

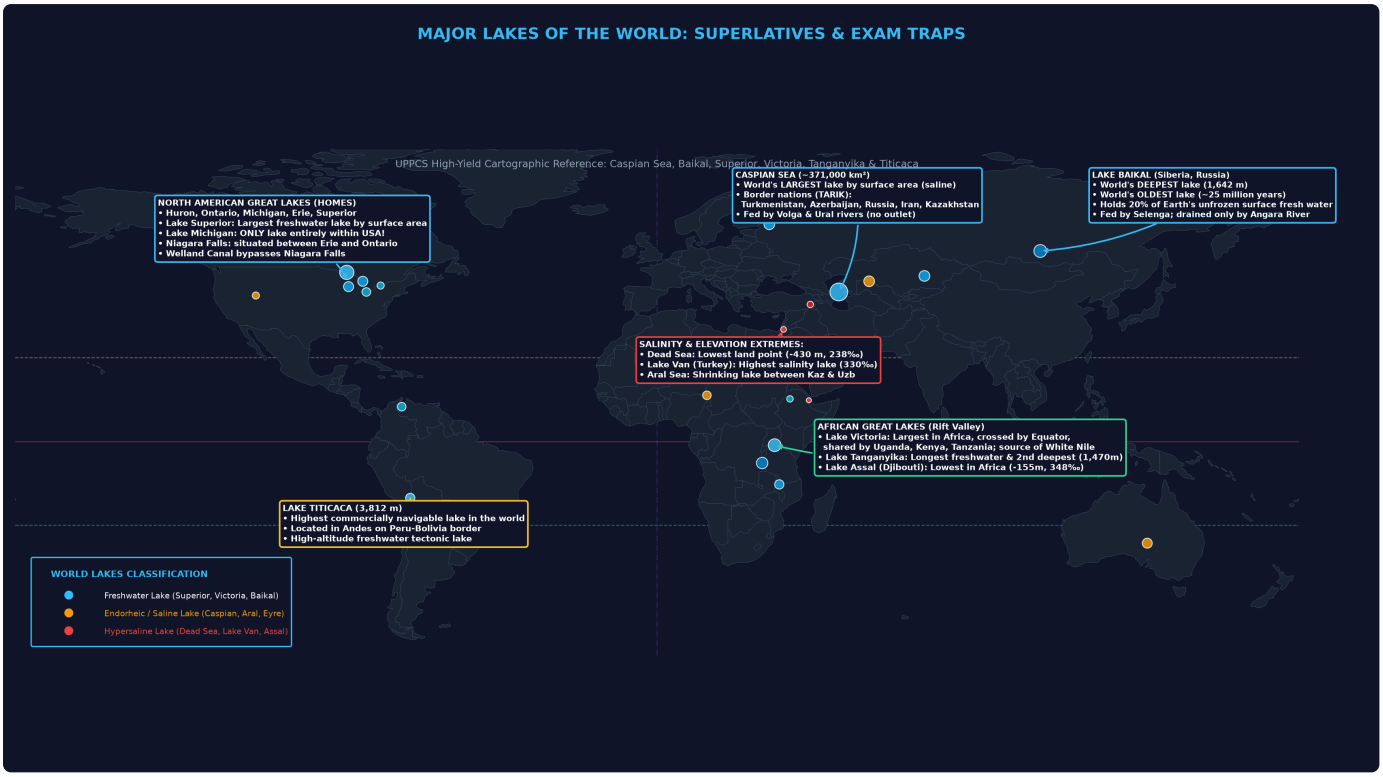
Dam	Country	River
Three Gorges	China	**Yangtze**
Itaipu	Brazil–Paraguay	**Paraná**
Guri	Venezuela	**Caroní**
Aswan High	Egypt	**Nile** (creates **Lake Nasser**)
Grand Coulee	USA	**Columbia**
Tucuruí	Brazil	**Tocantins**

Dam	Country	River
Robert-Bourassa	Canada	**La Grande**
Sayano-Shushenskaya	Russia	**Yenisei**
Tarbela	Pakistan	**Indus**
Nurek	Tajikistan	**Vakhsh**
GERD	Ethiopia	**Blue Nile**
Kariba	Zambia–Zimbabwe	**Zambezi**
Hoover	USA	**Colorado**
Akosombo	Ghana (घन)	Volta
Merowe	Sudan	Nile
Cahora Bassa	Mozambique	Zambezi
Xiaowan	China	Lancang / Mekong
Zangmu	Tibet (China)	Yarlung Tsangpo / Brahmaputra
Oroville	USA	Feather

Three chains to revise as one system

Chain	Path
Yangtze	Tibetan Plateau → China → **Three Gorges** → Shanghai belt → **East China Sea**
Nile	Victoria / Tana → Sudan–Egypt → **Aswan High Dam** → **Nile Delta** → **Mediterranean**
Paraná	Interior South America → **Itaipu** (Brazil–Paraguay) → Río de la Plata → **Atlantic**

N.7 Lakes



Learn **superlative** and **type**. Endorheic lakes have no ocean outlet.

Lake types

Type	Fact / example
Tectonic / rift	Baikal, Tanganyika, Dead Sea, Malawi
Glacial	Many Canadian and Alpine lakes. The Great Lakes have glacial history (इतिहास)
Crater / caldera	Crater Lake (USA). Lonar in India is impact, not volcanic
Lagoon / coastal	Chilika-type coastal idea. Barred coastal lakes
Oxbow	Cut-off meander lakes on floodplains
Endorheic	Caspian, Aral, Chad, Dead Sea, Eyre — inland, no sea outlet
Lake	Country
------	---------
Caspian	RU / IR / KZ / TM / AZ
Superior	USA–Canada
Baikal	**Russia**
Tanganyika	TZ / DRC / BI / ZM
Victoria	E Africa (TZ / UG / KE)
Michigan	**USA only**

Type	Fact / example
Huron	USA–Canada
Erie	USA–Canada
Ontario	USA–Canada
Onega	**Russia** (northwest)
Ladoga	Russia
Maracaibo	**Venezuela**
Dead Sea	Jordan–Israel
Titicaca	Peru–Bolivia
Aral	Kazakhstan–Uzbekistan
Chad	Africa (multi-state)
Eyre	Australia
Great Bear / Great Slave	Canada
Malawi / Nyasa	Africa rift

Great Lakes, west → east: Superior → Michigan → Huron → Erie → Ontario → St Lawrence. Mnemonic: **Super Man Helps Every One**. Together they hold about **20%** of the world's surface freshwater.

East → west reverse: Ontario → Erie → Huron → Michigan → Superior.

Lakes desk (GC extras)

Lake / pair	Fact
Faguibine	Mali (W Africa) — dried / desertified
Balkhash	**Kazakhstan**
Finger Lakes	New York, **USA**
Boiling Lake	Dominica
Five Flower Lake	Sichuan, **China** (not Mongolia)
Red Lagoon	Bolivia
Urmia	Iran
Reindeer / Athabasca	**Canada** (Uranium City near Athabasca)
Plitvice	Croatia — UNESCO lake park
Great Lakes E→W	Ontario → Erie → Huron → Michigan → Superior
Cities	Duluth on Superior. Chicago on Michigan. Buffalo on Erie. Detroit on the Detroit River

Lake / pair	Fact
Victoria	Shared by Tanzania, Uganda and Kenya (**three** countries). Rift-associated. White Nile outflow near Jinja
Volume ladder (fresh note)	Caspian (saline) > Baikal > Tanganyika > Superior > Malawi
Area ladder (fresh, approximate coaching order)	**Superior** → **Victoria** → **Huron** → **Michigan** → **Tanganyika** → **Baikal** → **Great Bear** → **Malawi** → **Great Slave** → **Erie** → **Winnipeg** → **Ontario**

Freshwater area order (largest → smaller, standard coaching set): Lake **Superior** is first by surface area. Then come **Victoria**, **Huron**, and **Michigan**. Next are African–Siberian names **Tanganyika** and **Baikal**, then Canadian **Great Bear**, African **Malawi** (Nyasa), Canadian **Great Slave**, Great Lakes **Erie**, Canadian **Winnipeg**, and Great Lakes **Ontario**. Figures shift slightly by source; treat this as the usual top set, not a millimetre-exact USGS dump.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q66

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

A. Michigan — USA

B. Baikal — Russia

C. Onega — Canada

D. Maracaibo — Venezuela

Show answer

Ans: C — Onega is in **Russia**.

N.8 Waterfalls

Identity: Highest is not the same as widest, and neither is the same as most famous.

Fact **Angel** for height.

Fact **Victoria** for the Zambezi / Zambia–Zimbabwe pair.

Fall	River / basin	Countries	
Angel	Churún (Caroní / Orinoco)	**Venezuela**	**Highest** on Earth
Tugela	Tugela	South Africa	Usual 2nd-height fact
Victoria	**Zambezi**	Zambia–Zimbabwe	Not the highest
Niagara	Niagara (Erie → Ontario)	USA–Canada	
Iguazu / Iguaçu	Iguazu (Paraná system)	Brazil–Argentina	
Ribbon	Ribbon Creek	California (Yosemite)	

Fall	River / basin	Countries	
Browne	—	New Zealand	high fall note
Yosemite	Yosemite Creek	USA (California)	

Angel Falls on the Churún (Orinoco system) in **Venezuela** is the world's highest waterfall.

Tugela Falls in South Africa is the usual second-height fact.

Victoria Falls sits on the **Zambezi** between Zambia and Zimbabwe.

Victoria is famous, but it is **not** the highest.

Niagara Falls sits on the Niagara River between Lake Erie and Lake Ontario on the USA–Canada border.

Iguazu / Iguaçu sits on the Paraná system between Brazil and Argentina.
